

HOW IT TRANSFORMED MY LIFE

"Life is much easier now"

PAPINDER KAUR, 46
Homemaker, Kalkaji Extension, Delhi

"I've completely forgotten the hassle of cylinders," says Papinder, who switched to PNG in 2021. "Life is much easier now." Keeping track, booking replacements and storing spares was a constant struggle, especially with frequent guests. "Every 15-20 days, we needed a replacement," she recalls. In Delhi, households get 12 subsidised cylinders yearly, after which full-price ones add financial pressure. Additionally, middle-class homes often lack space for spare cylinders. "Now, we pay for what we consume.... With piped gas, the stress is gone," she says.

So far, Indraprastha Gas Limited (IGL) has provided piped gas to 2.9 million households in Delhi NCR. Last year, it expanded to connect villages, aiming to inspire more families to switch to the cleaner fuel. However, the challenge remains: building infrastructure quickly and ensuring steady supplies, as gas is an imported commodity. The hope is to see more smiles like Papinder's. ■

126.3 million connections by 2032. To achieve this, India is divided into 307 geographical areas covering 733 districts across 34 states and Union territories. This will ensure a potential 100 per cent coverage.

"PNG offers multiple advantages," says A. Ramana Kumar, who is a member of the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB). "It is environmentally friendly, safer and does away with the need for extensive road transportation [of cylinders], thus reducing vehicular pollution." When compared to LPG, natural gas is less toxic. Its lighter-than-air properties make it safer too. Additionally, the pay-as-you-consume model alleviates household budgeting concerns. It may be slightly more expensive than subsidised LPG, but PNG's overall benefits make it more than worth it. ■